

RDC Memory & Changing Needs Safety Plan

A non-clinical family worksheet for organizing what has changed, what could affect safety or independence, and what needs follow-up.

Important: This does not diagnose dementia or determine capacity. New or worsening confusion, memory, judgment, or behavior changes should be discussed with an appropriate healthcare professional. Sudden confusion or an immediate safety threat can require urgent help.

1 | WHAT HAS CHANGED?

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	Repeating questions or stories more than before	
☐	Missed appointments or difficulty following instructions	
☐	Medication organization is becoming harder	
☐	Getting lost, disoriented, or confused in familiar places	
☐	Driving concerns or new near-misses	
☐	Unpaid bills, duplicate payments, unusual purchases, or scams	
☐	Cooking left unattended / food safety concerns	
☐	Changes in hygiene, clothing, or housekeeping	
☐	Difficulty using phone, medical alert, remote, appliances, or familiar technology	
☐	Nighttime confusion, wandering, or leaving the home unexpectedly	
☐	New isolation, anxiety, irritability, grief, or withdrawal	
☐	Family members disagree about how serious the changes are	

2 | HOME & DAILY-LIFE SAFETY

Check	Item	Notes / status
☐	Walking paths and exits are easy to identify and use.	
☐	The person can safely use the stove / appliances they currently rely on.	
☐	Medications are organized in a way that matches current ability.	
☐	Door / key / lock routines are manageable without creating unsafe lockout or wandering risk.	
☐	Emergency contact information is visible and understandable.	
☐	The person can reliably summon help.	

Check	Item	Notes / status
[]	Family knows how often someone is checking in.	
[]	Food, hydration, and groceries are being maintained.	
[]	Transportation plan does not depend on unsafe driving.	

3 | WHO IS WATCHING WHAT?

Area	Primary person	How often checked?	What change would trigger action?
Medication organization			
Appointments			
Meals / groceries			
Driving / transportation			
Bills / unusual charges			
Home safety			
Social connection			
Medical follow-up			
Emergency access			
Technology / alert devices			

4 | QUESTIONS FOR THE NEXT MEDICAL APPOINTMENT

Check	Item	Notes / status
[]	What specific changes have we noticed, and when did they start?	
[]	Could medication effects, infection, sleep problems, hearing/vision issues, mood, pain, or another health issue be contributing?	
[]	Should a cognitive assessment or specialist referral be considered?	
[]	Are there medication or driving-safety concerns to discuss?	
[]	What changes would require urgent medical attention?	
[]	What local support or caregiver resources would be appropriate now?	

5 | FAMILY PLAN IF THINGS CHANGE

Who responds first	
Who can get into the home	
Who communicates with healthcare providers	
Who handles transportation	
Who monitors bills / scams	
Who is backup if the primary person is unavailable	

6 | TOP 5 NEXT STEPS

Priority	Action	Who	By when
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			